



can provide compelling advice that steers a customer toward making a purchase. Make sure to incorporate the desired qualities into your job description (see pp.124–125) when recruiting for a sales role.

Representing the business

Salespeople may be the only contact customers have with your business. They represent the face of the organization, so you need sales staff you can trust to handle customers well, who believe in your business vision, and operate in a way that reflects its values. It takes time and hard work to build a positive brand reputation and customer loyalty, all of which can be lost easily through bad sales experiences.



BE AWARE

- › **When setting goals** for sales staff, do not lose sight of other business objectives, such as customer satisfaction and profit margins.
- › **Ensure targets** are set against goals that will stretch staff. Easy targets can breed complacency.
- › **Encourage drive** and determination in staff, but watch out for rivalries that can unbalance a team. Use different approaches toward different personalities.
- › **Leave selling** to sales staff. You should not be in competition with them but rather be their guide.

“I have never worked a day in my life without selling. If I believe in something, I sell it, and I sell it hard.”

Estée Lauder, US businesswoman, 1985



Empower staff

- › **Allow** staff the freedom and authority to interact directly with customers.
- › **Trust** them to manage customers and to learn from mistakes.

Push the positives

- › **Create** a culture of achievement by sharing long-term strategies and good-news stories.
- › **Reward** the team for their successes.